

Local SEO Checklist

A practical worksheet for Google Business Profile, local landing pages, reviews, citations, and local measurement

Website / Business: _____	Audit date: _____
Auditor: _____	Scope / URL set: _____
Primary market: _____	Revision: _____

Purpose	A repeatable local-search audit for businesses serving customers in a defined geographic area. It focuses on accurate business representation, local relevance, website signals, and measurement.
Scope	Use for storefront, service-area, or hybrid businesses. Apply only the profile and location rules that fit the actual business model and physical/service footprint.

How to use this worksheet

- [] Review every item that applies to the audited site or profile. Mark N/A only when the item genuinely does not apply.
- [] Record evidence such as URL, screenshot, HTTP response, Search Console report, Business Profile field, or test result.
- [] Fix in dependency order: access and crawlability first, then indexability and canonicalization, then page/content quality, then measurement and ongoing maintenance.

Status key	[] Pass	[] Needs work	[] N/A	[] Verified
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Primary references include Google Business Profile Help, Google Search Central, and Search Console Help. Local rankings vary by query, location, device, competition, and other signals; this is a quality-control checklist, not a ranking guarantee.

01 Business Profile eligibility and setup

Audit objective: Confirm the business is represented accurately and that the profile configuration matches how customers actually interact with the business.

Eligibility and ownership

- [] Confirm the business meets Google Business Profile eligibility requirements for a physical location customers can visit or a service business that travels to customers.
- [] Confirm the profile is claimed and verified by the business owner or an authorized manager.
- [] Confirm the business retains owner access and third-party managers do not control the account without authorization.
- [] Check for duplicate profiles or competing profile records for the same business/location and resolve them through Google's procedures rather than creating extra profiles.

Business name and category

- [] Use the real-world business name consistently; do not add service keywords, locations, slogans, phone numbers, URLs, or other unnecessary text to the name.
- [] Choose the fewest categories needed to describe the core business accurately, with the most specific representative primary category available.
- [] Add additional categories only when they genuinely describe the business rather than nearby businesses, attributes, or keyword targets.
- [] Record the current primary category and rationale so future edits remain consistent.

Contact details and hours

- [] Confirm the phone number is under the business's direct control and routes customers to the correct business/location.
- [] Confirm website URL points to the actual business site or appropriate location page.
- [] Verify regular hours and special/holiday hours match real customer-facing availability.
- [] Check name, address, phone, and hours against the website and other major business records for accidental conflicts.

Notes:

02 Address, service area, and local relevance

Audit objective: Match the profile to the business model and avoid misleading location signals.

Storefront and hybrid businesses

- [] Confirm the listed address is a real operating location where the business can appropriately receive customers, where required by Google policy.
- [] Confirm permanent signage and real-world representation support the public location when an address is displayed.
- [] If the business serves customers at its location and also travels to customers, configure the profile as a hybrid business as appropriate.
- [] Verify the map pin is placed accurately and does not point to a neighboring property.

Service-area businesses

- [] If customers do not visit the business at its address, hide the address and use a service area that accurately reflects where the business serves customers.
- [] Set service areas using supported cities, postal codes, or areas that the business actually serves; do not create an artificial radius or location list solely for keyword targeting.
- [] Check for stale service areas after service-territory changes.

[] Avoid creating separate profiles for each service area when Google permits only one profile for the service business/location.

Local website architecture

- [] Create or maintain a clear contact/location page with accurate business information and directions where applicable.
- [] For multiple genuine locations, give each location its own useful page rather than publishing near-duplicate location pages with little unique value.
- [] Include locally relevant services, areas served, customer information, and other useful details naturally within page content.
- [] Avoid doorway-style pages created only to capture searches for many cities without substantive, unique local value.

Notes:

03 Google Business Profile completeness

Audit objective: Make the profile useful for customers and internally consistent with the business website.

Services and business description

- [] Populate the services/products that the business actually offers, using the available service editor options.
- [] Use clear service descriptions and pricing only where appropriate and accurate; do not use custom service names for keyword stuffing, phone numbers, gibberish, or unrelated content.
- [] Write a useful business description focused on services, products, mission, and relevant history; do not use the description as a keyword list or promotional spam block.
- [] Confirm the website, phone, service areas, category, and hours in the profile are current.

Photos and media

- [] Add authentic, current photos that help customers understand the storefront, team, services, products, or service experience.
- [] Use sharp, well-lit images that represent the business accurately and follow Google's content/quality requirements.
- [] Replace outdated visuals after a rebrand, relocation, or major change in services.
- [] Keep important website images and profile visuals consistent with the real-world business.

Customer actions and links

- [] Use the profile's available action links where they help customers book, reserve, order, or view relevant services.
- [] Test each profile link on desktop and mobile and verify the destination matches the intended action.
- [] Track meaningful website conversions coming from local profile traffic when your analytics implementation supports it.

Notes:

04 Reviews and reputation

Audit objective: Build a compliant, authentic review process that helps customers evaluate the business.

Review acquisition

- [] Create a simple process for asking real customers for honest reviews after genuine interactions.
- [] Use Google's review link or QR-code workflow where appropriate.
- [] Do not offer payment, discounts, free goods/services, or other incentives in exchange for reviews, changes to reviews, or removal of negative reviews.

[] Do not manufacture reviews, ask customers to review from multiple accounts, or manipulate review volume/rating patterns.

Review response

- [] Respond to reviews professionally and specifically enough to show that feedback is being addressed.
- [] Use negative reviews as an operational feedback source; do not pressure reviewers to remove criticism in exchange for incentives or other benefits.
- [] Escalate clear policy violations through Google's reporting processes and preserve evidence when appropriate.

Reputation consistency

- [] Audit major review platforms for the correct business name, URL, location, and contact details.
- [] Watch for duplicate listings, outdated business profiles, or profiles that could confuse customers about the current business.
- [] Document notable recurring customer questions or complaints and use them to improve local landing-page content or service information.

Notes:

05 Local website SEO and structured data

Audit objective: Connect the local business entity, services, places served, and site architecture without over-optimization.

Local on-page signals

- [] Use the business/location name and service terminology naturally in the title, main heading, copy, and relevant link text where appropriate.
- [] Make contact information easy to find and ensure it is consistent with the Business Profile.
- [] Include meaningful location context where it helps users understand the service area; do not force city names into every heading or paragraph.
- [] Ensure calls to action such as call, book, request a quote, or get directions work on mobile.

LocalBusiness structured data

- [] Use LocalBusiness structured data on pages that contain real business information and select the most specific applicable subtype.
- [] Keep structured-data name, URL, contact, address/service-area, and other supported properties consistent with visible page content and the actual business.
- [] Validate structured data with Google's Rich Results Test when a supported rich-result feature applies and review Search Console after deployment.
- [] For multiple real-world locations, define each location accurately rather than inventing locations to target additional markets.

Site architecture and internal links

- [] Link location/service pages from the main navigation, relevant service pages, and other useful internal pages where appropriate.
- [] Use descriptive anchor text that identifies the destination rather than repeating exact-match city terms everywhere.
- [] Avoid thin location pages that repeat identical text with only the city name changed.
- [] Maintain canonical URLs, clean redirects, and crawlable HTML links for important local pages.

Notes:

06 Citations, local authority, and measurement

Audit objective: Strengthen consistency and learn from local search behavior without relying on spammy listing volume.

Business citations and mentions

- [] Create a master NAP record: exact business name, address or service-area representation, phone, URL, and key profile details.
- [] Audit important directories, chambers, associations, industry sites, and local organizations for consistency and accuracy.
- [] Prioritize relevant, trustworthy sources rather than mass-submitting the business to low-quality directories.
- [] Correct outdated or duplicate listings when they materially confuse customers or search engines.

Local authority and community signals

- [] Document legitimate local partnerships, sponsorships, memberships, community involvement, local events, and relevant organizations that may result in useful mentions or links.
- [] Earn local links and mentions because of useful work, resources, expertise, or genuine community relationships rather than automated link schemes.
- [] Create locally useful resources that answer real customer questions instead of producing pages solely to capture location keywords.

Measurement

- [] Track local organic queries, clicks, impressions, click-through rate, and landing pages in Search Console.
- [] Track Business Profile performance and customer actions available in the current Business Profile interface.
- [] Use a defined list of target services and locations for rank monitoring; record device, search location, date, and tracking method so measurements are reproducible.
- [] Track calls, form submissions, appointment requests, directions, and other business outcomes instead of relying only on ranking position.
- [] Compare performance over consistent time windows and document major profile, site, service-area, or market changes before interpreting trend movement.

Notes:

Local SEO audit summary

Use this page to turn the audit into a focused implementation plan. Record the evidence and the exact field/page/listing that needs to change.

Priority and evidence log

Priority	Finding / evidence	Action / owner	Status
P0	Eligibility, verification, duplicate, or severe profile accuracy issue		[]
P1	Wrong name/category/address/service-area/phone/website/hours		[]
P1	Critical local landing page, indexability, or structured-data issue		[]
P2	Reviews, citations, internal links, media, or conversion-path improvement		[]
P3	Content expansion, local authority, testing, or reporting refinement		[]

Final local QA

- [] Business Profile name reflects the real-world business name and does not contain location/service keyword stuffing.
- [] Primary category is the best factual description of the core business, with only relevant additional categories.
- [] Address/service-area setup matches whether customers visit the location or the business travels to customers.
- [] Phone, website, hours, services, description, and service areas are current and consistent with the website.
- [] Website local pages are useful, indexable, internally linked, and materially different where multiple locations exist.
- [] LocalBusiness structured data, when used, describes real visible business information and passes validation checks.
- [] Review requests are authentic and comply with Google policies; no incentives or review manipulation are used.
- [] Key citations/directories are accurate, relevant, and free of obvious duplicates or conflicting information.
- [] Local performance is measured using search data and business outcomes, not only rank position.
- [] Changes are documented with date, evidence, owner, and verification result.

Authoritative references

Google Business Profile guidelines: <https://support.google.com/business/answer/3038177>
 Get started with Google Business Profile: <https://support.google.com/business/answer/7039811>
 Service business overview: <https://support.google.com/business/answer/10514743>
 Service areas: <https://support.google.com/business/answer/9157481>
 Manage services: <https://support.google.com/business/answer/9455399>
 Reviews guidance: <https://support.google.com/business/answer/3474122>
 Review link / QR code: <https://support.google.com/business/answer/16816815>
 Local Business structured data: <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/structured-data/local-business>
 Search Essentials: <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/essentials>
 URL Inspection: <https://support.google.com/webmasters/answer/9012289>
 Search Console Performance: <https://support.google.com/webmasters/answer/7576553>

Important: Google Business Profile policies, service-area rules, interface options, and Search features can change. Review the current official documentation before making profile edits or promising specific local-search results.